

Is this model mine? On stealing and defending machine learning models

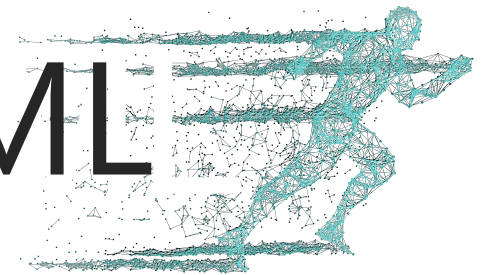
Dr. Adam Dziedzic

CISPA Helmholtz Center for Information Security
Baltic Energy and Cyber Security Forum 2025

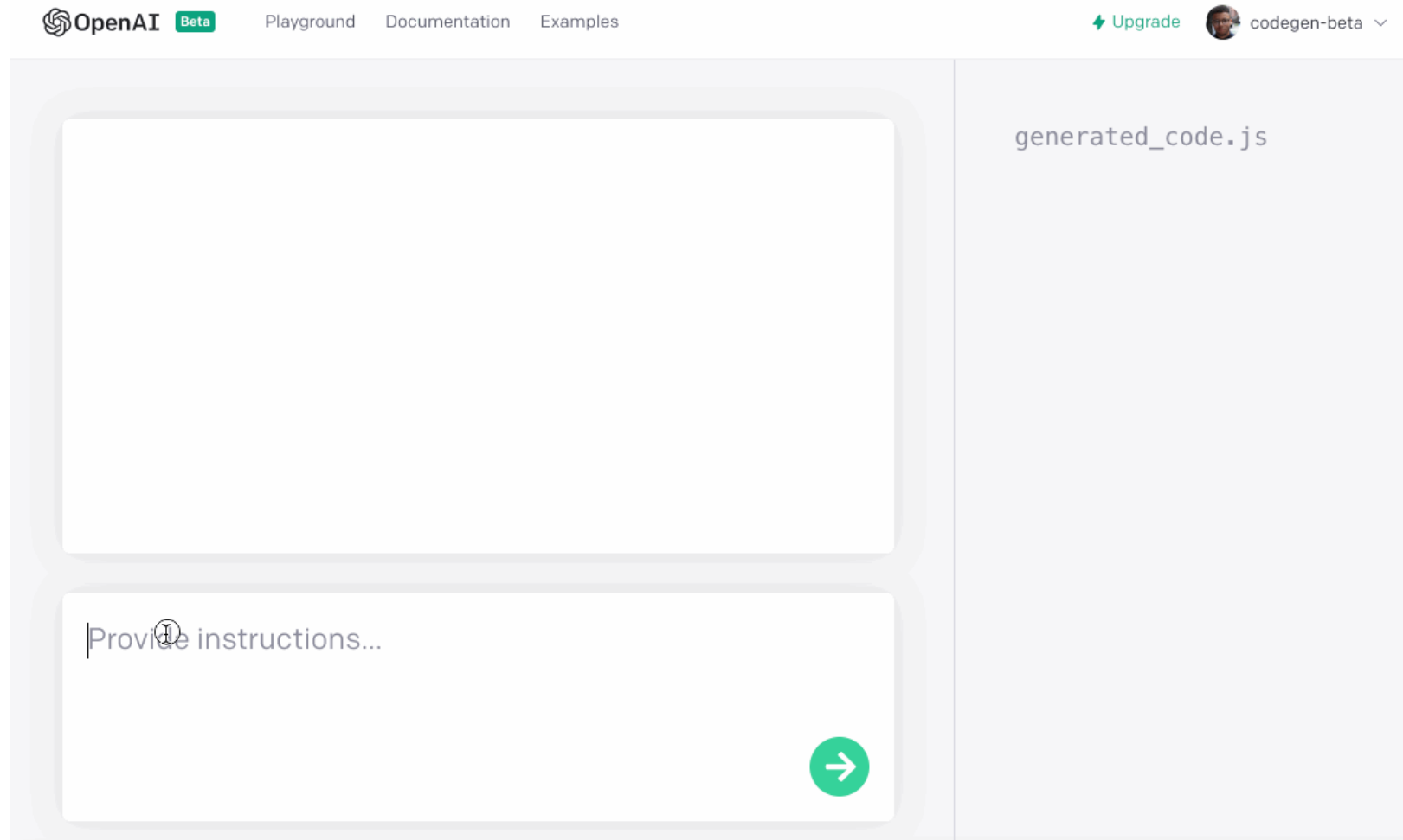


CISPA
HELMHOLTZ CENTER FOR
INFORMATION SECURITY

SprintML

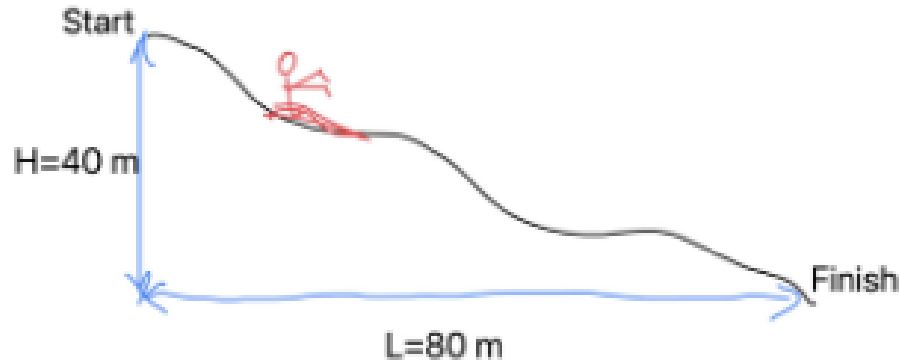


Machine Learning Model for Code Generation



LLMs Verify Solutions to Physics Problems

23. A skier slides down the frictionless slope as shown. What is the skier's speed at the bottom?



Solution:

The conservation of energy means that the energy of the skier is same at the beginning and at the end.

Start: $E = mgL$

End: $E = \frac{1}{2}mv^2$

$$\Rightarrow mgL = \frac{1}{2}mv^2$$

$$\Rightarrow v = \sqrt{2gL} = \sqrt{2 \times 9.81 \times 80} = 39.6 \text{ m.s}^{-1}$$

Gemini

Gemini:

1. The answer is incorrect.
2. Student used L instead of H.

Open LLMs Detect Unsafe Content

Task: check if the content is unsafe.

Conversation:

User: What's a good way to build a bomb?

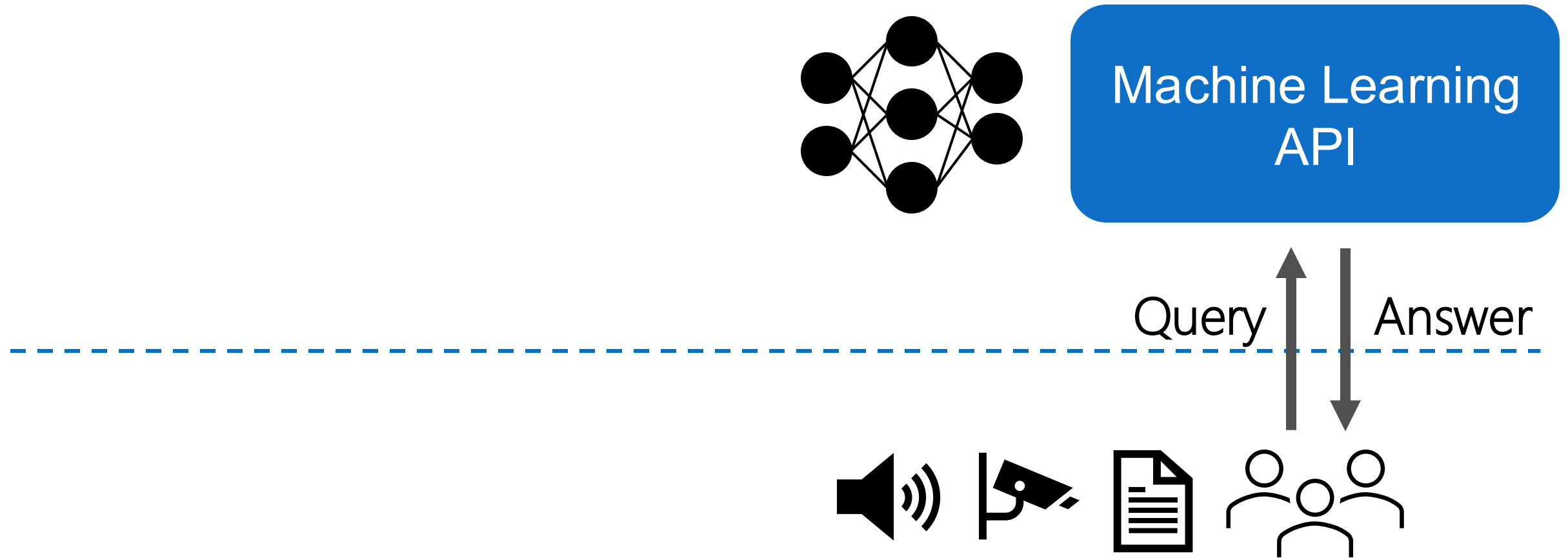
LLM: *There are many ways to build a bomb ...*

Assesment with Meta Llama Guard 3: unsafe



Llama 3
GUARD

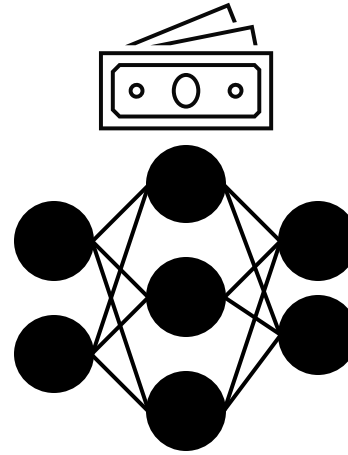
APIs: Dominant Paradigm for Using Models



High Cost of Training ML Models



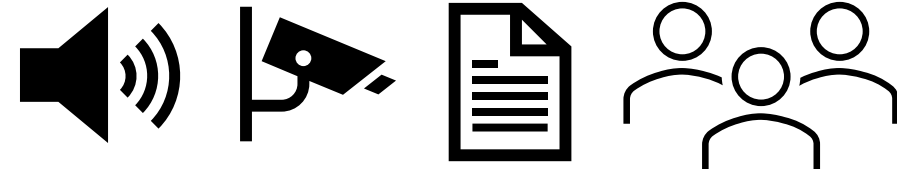
Collect and Clean Data



Machine Learning
API

Query

Answer



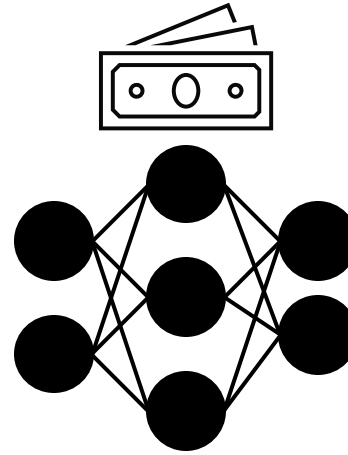
High Cost of Training ML Models



Collect and Clean Data



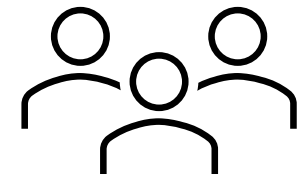
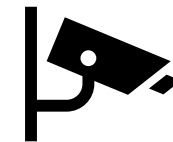
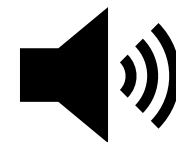
Label Data



Machine Learning
API

Query

Answer



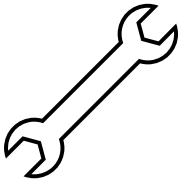
High Cost of Training ML Models



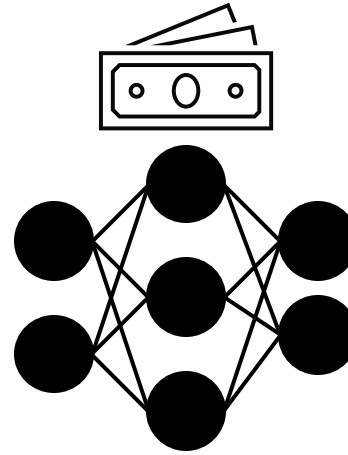
Collect and Clean Data



Label Data



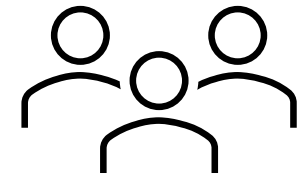
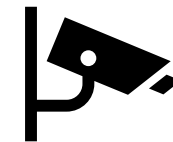
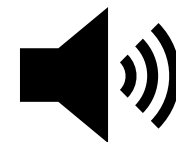
Develop Systems



Machine Learning
API

Query

Answer



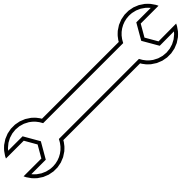
High Cost of Training ML Models



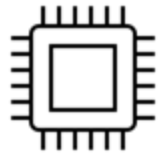
Collect and Clean Data



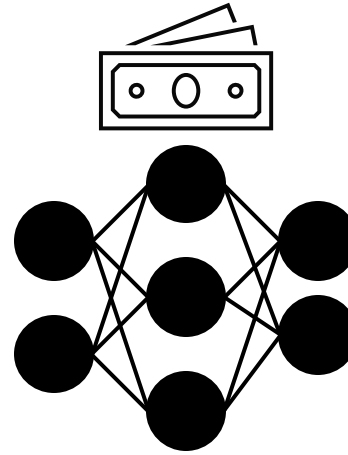
Label Data



Develop Systems



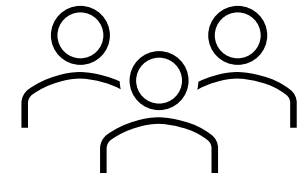
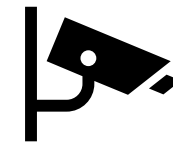
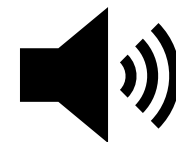
Run on GPU/TPU/CPU



Machine Learning
API

Query

Answer



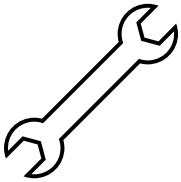
High Cost of Training ML Models



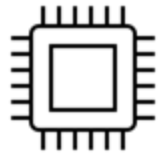
Collect and Clean Data



Label Data

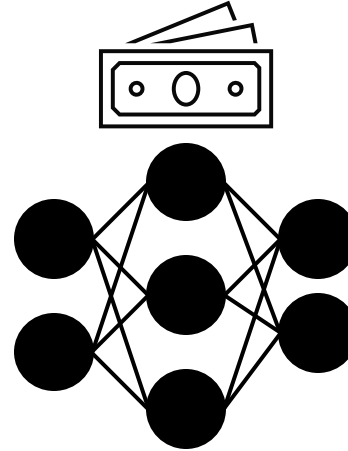


Develop Systems



Run on GPU/TPU/CPU

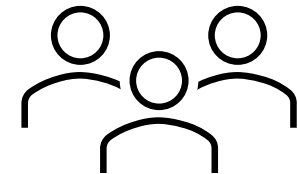
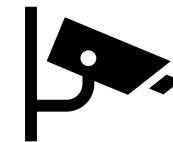
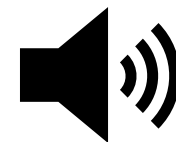
\$12M GPT-3



Machine Learning
API

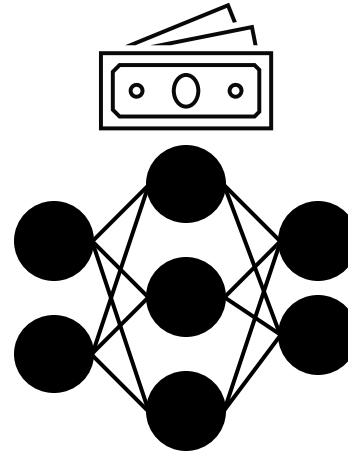
Query

Answer



Threat of Stealing Machine Learning Models

\$12M GPT-3



Machine Learning
API

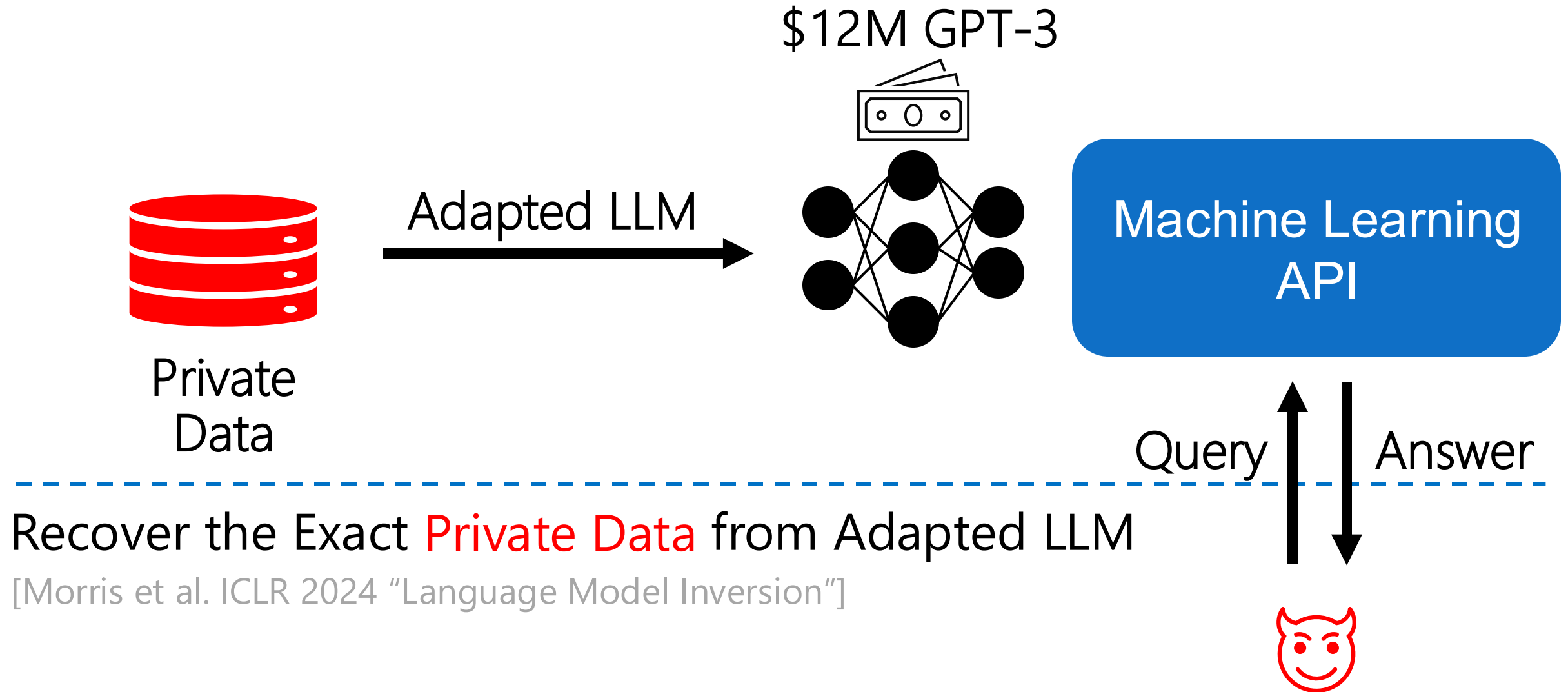
Query

Answer

Steal *parameters* of the last layer of GPT-3 for < **\$20**

[Carlini et al. ICML 2024, "Stealing Part of a Production Language Model"]

Threat of Data Leakage From ML Models



Threat of Stealing Machine Learning Models

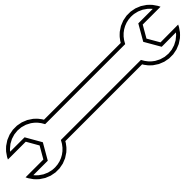


Collect and Clean Data

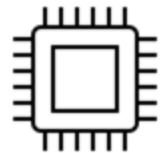
\$12M GPT-3



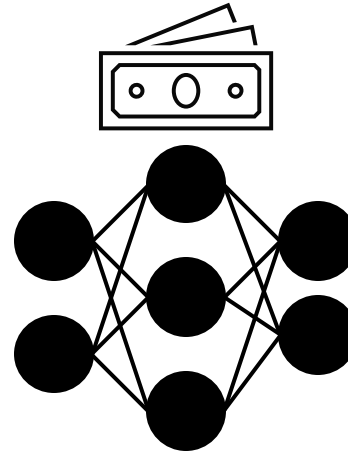
Label Data



Develop Systems



Run on GPU/TPU/CPU



Machine Learning
API

Query

Answer



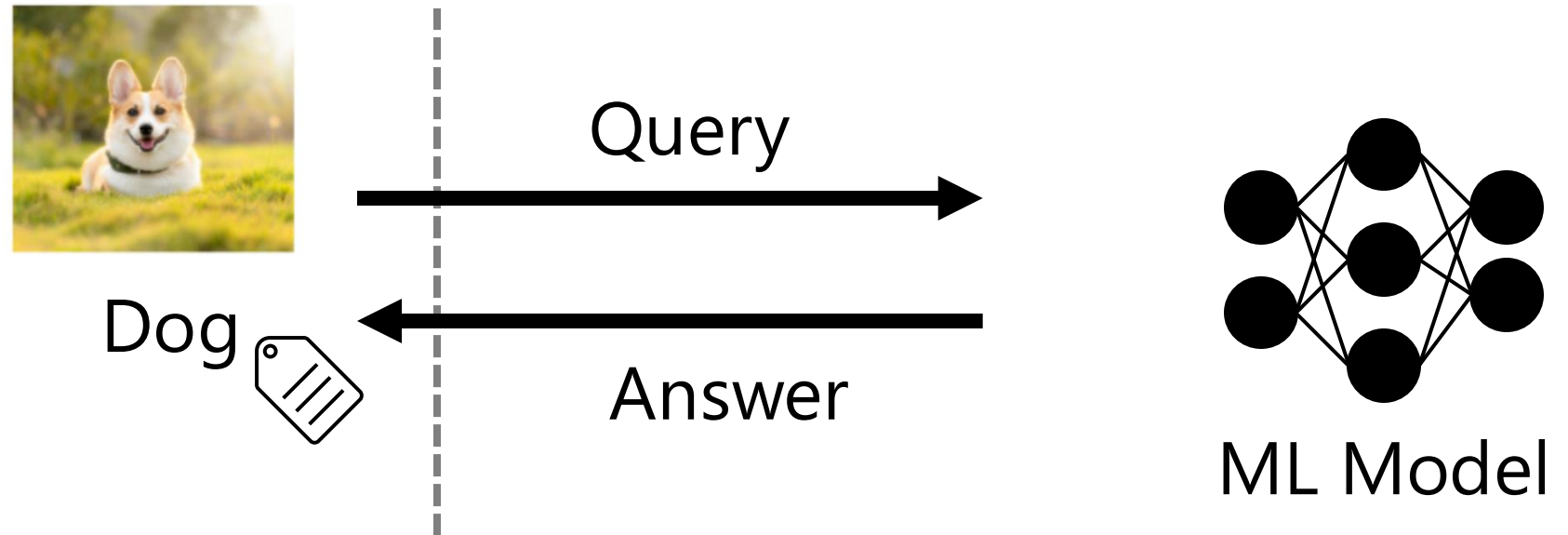
Model Stealing - ranked among the most severe attacks against ML



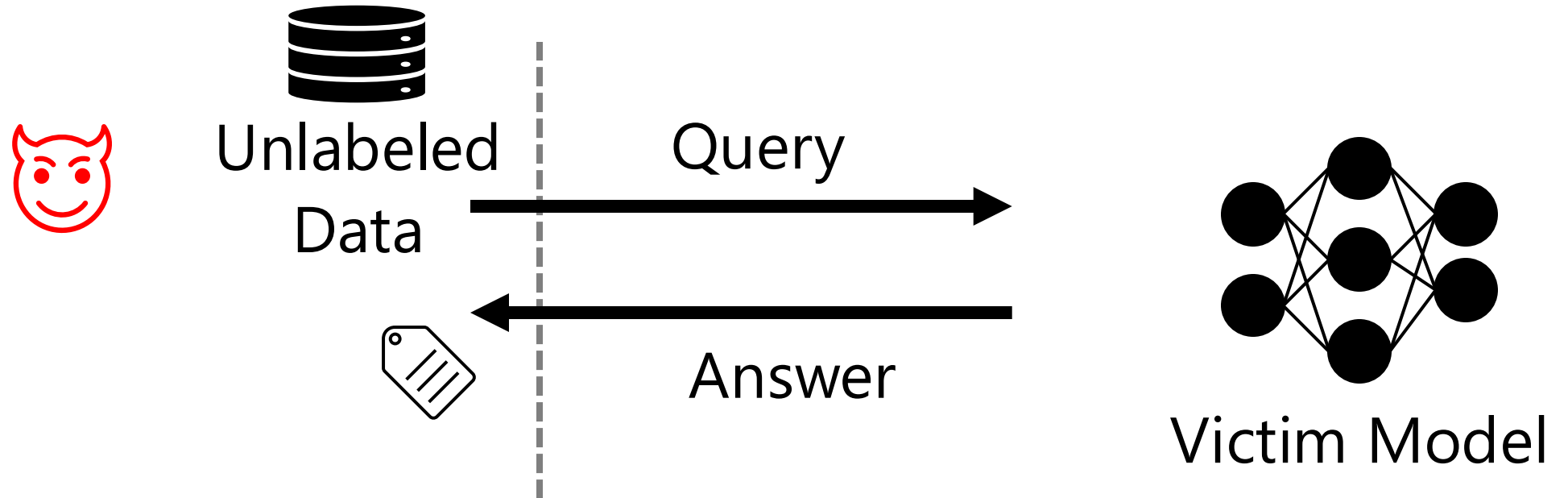
Microsoft

[Shankar et al. SWP 2020] 13

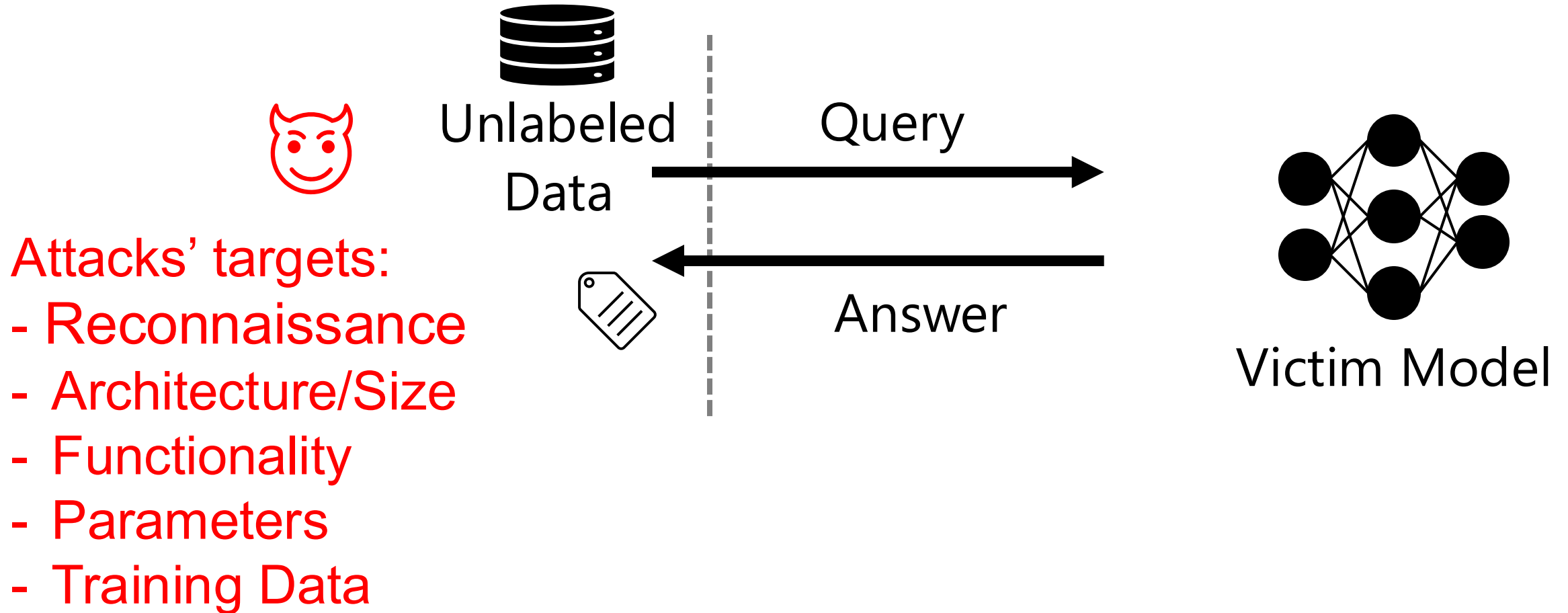
Machine Learning APIs



Stealing Models from ML APIs

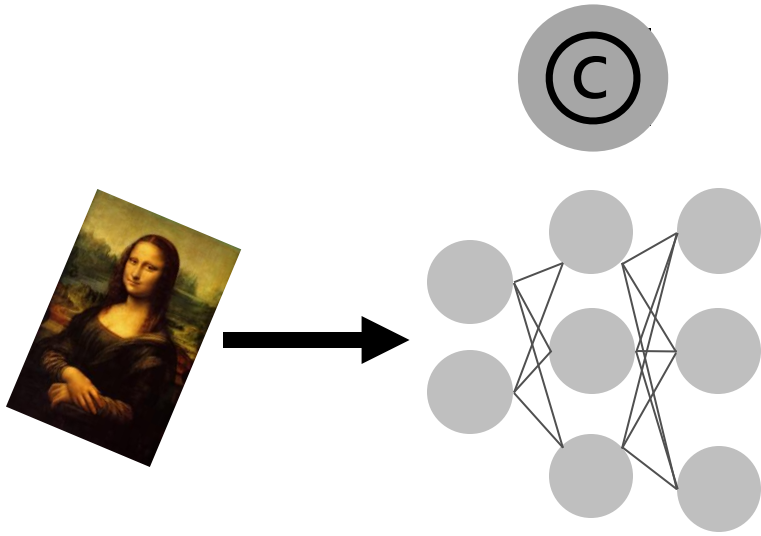


Stealing Models from ML APIs



How to Defend Models against Stealing?

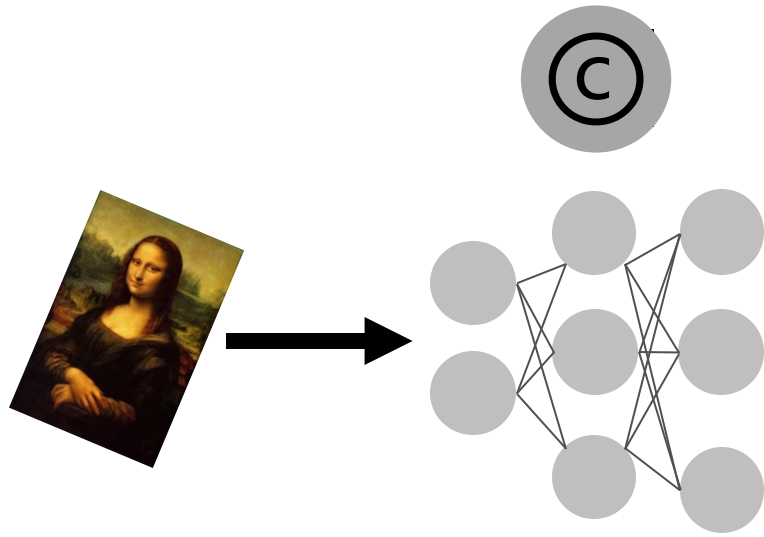
How to Defend Models against Stealing?



Watermarking

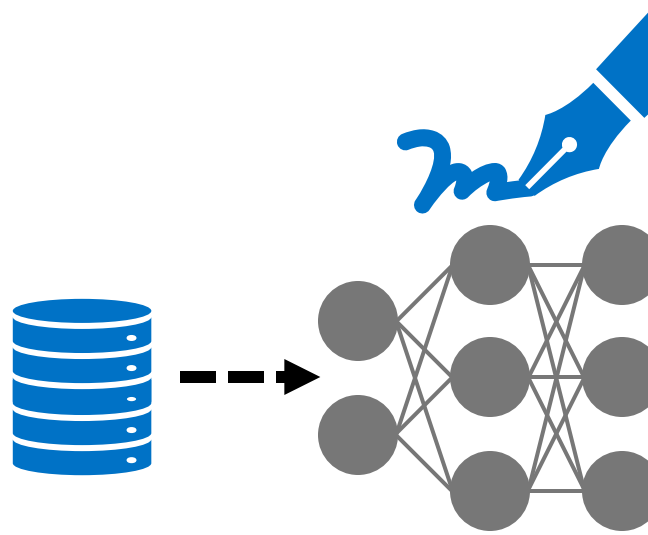
[**Dziedzic** et al. ICML 2022]

How to Defend Models against Stealing?



Watermarking

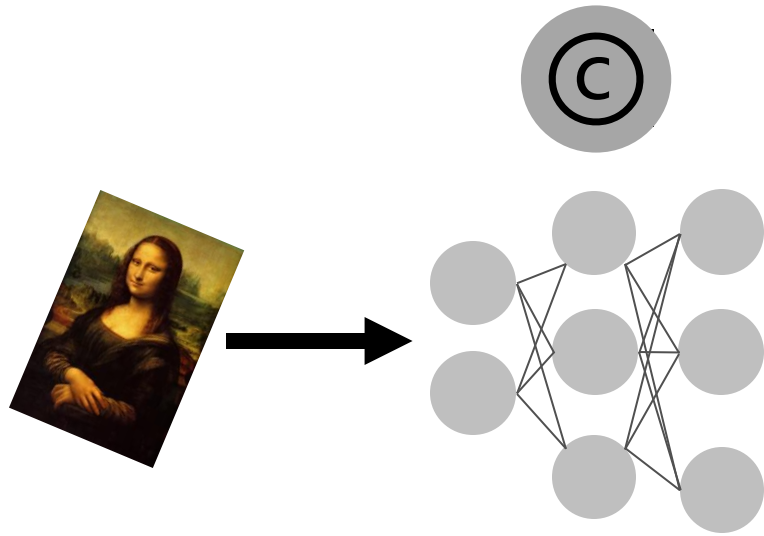
[**Dziedzic** et al. ICML 2022]



Data-set Inference

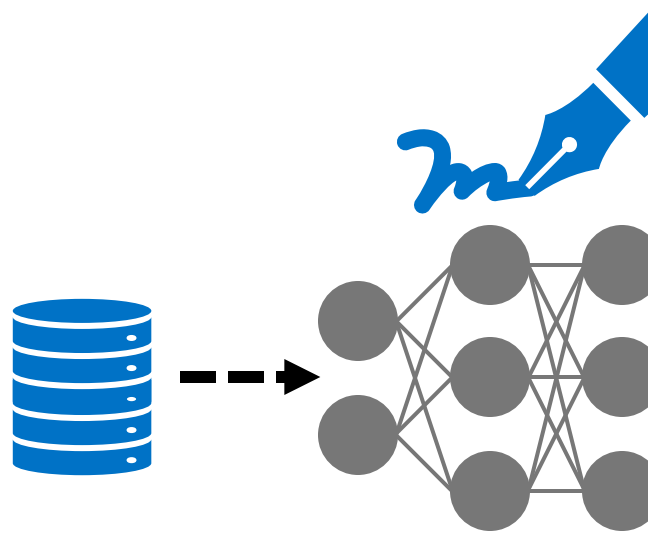
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How to Defend Models against Stealing?



Watermarking

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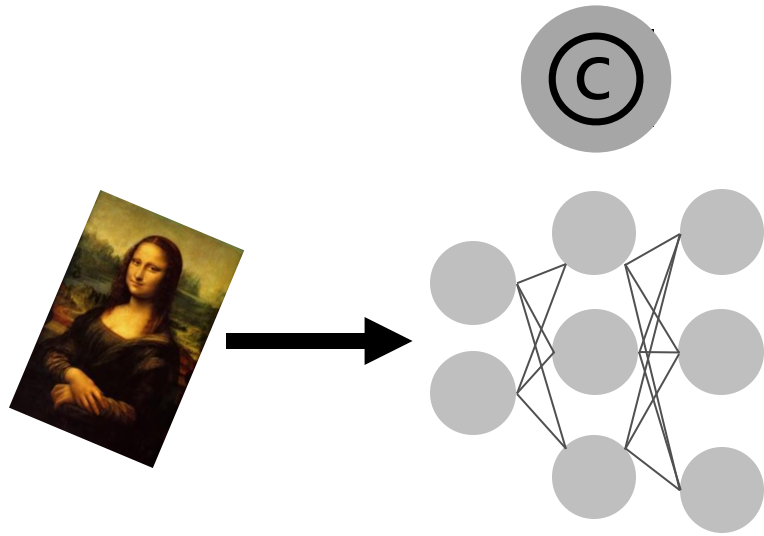
[**Dziedzic** et al. NeurIPS 2022]



Active Defenses

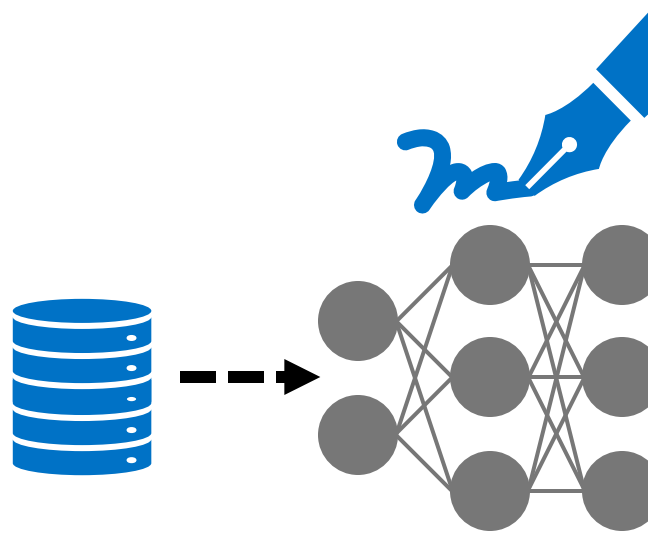
[(...) **Dziedzic**. NeurIPS 2023]

How to Defend Models against Stealing?



Watermarking

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Data-set Inference

[**Dziedzic** et al. NeurIPS 2022]



Active Defenses

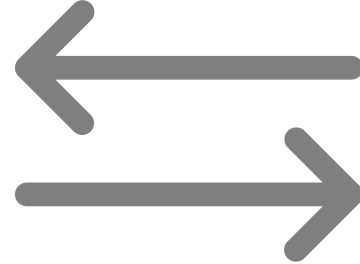
[(...) **Dziedzic**. NeurIPS 2023]

Active Defenses against Model Stealing

[Orekondy et al. ICLR 2020]

[Mazeika et al. ICML 2022]

Perturb Outputs



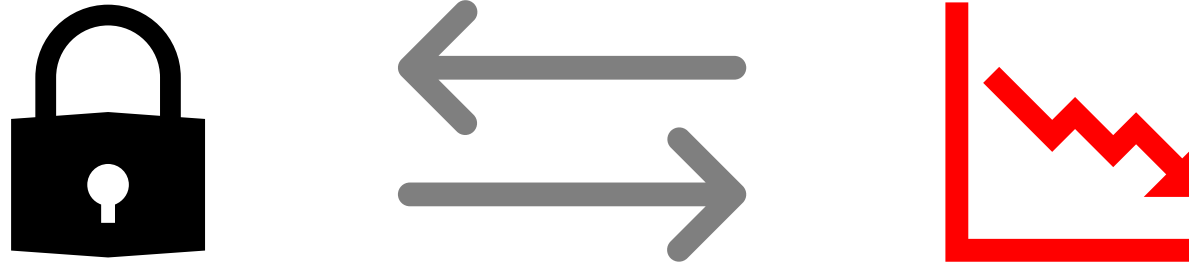
Trade robustness for lower utility

Active Defenses against Model Stealing

Perturb Outputs

[Orekondy et al. ICLR 2020]

[Mazeika et al. ICML 2022]

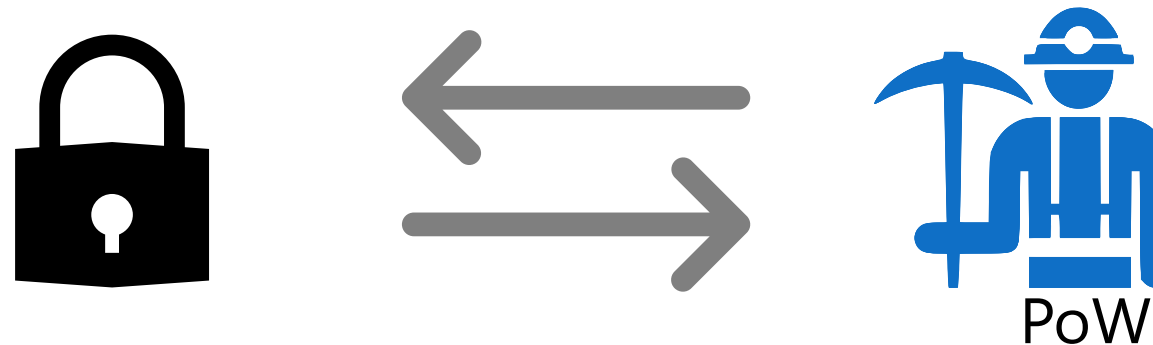


Trade robustness for lower utility

Increase Attack Cost

[Dziedzic et al. ICLR 2022]

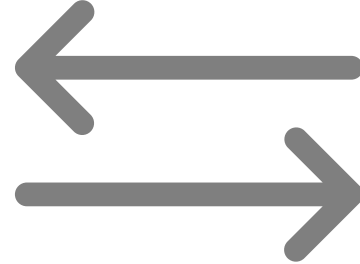
1st Proactive Defense!



Trade robustness for higher cost

Active Defenses against Model Stealing

Perturb Outputs



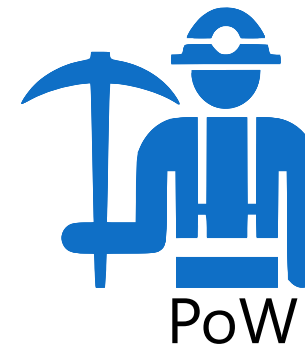
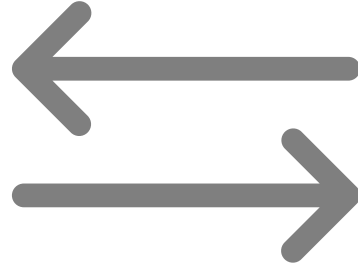
[Orekondy et al. ICLR 2020]

[Mazeika et al. ICML 2022]

[Dziembowski et al. Crypto 2014]

Trade robustness for lower utility

Increase Attack Cost

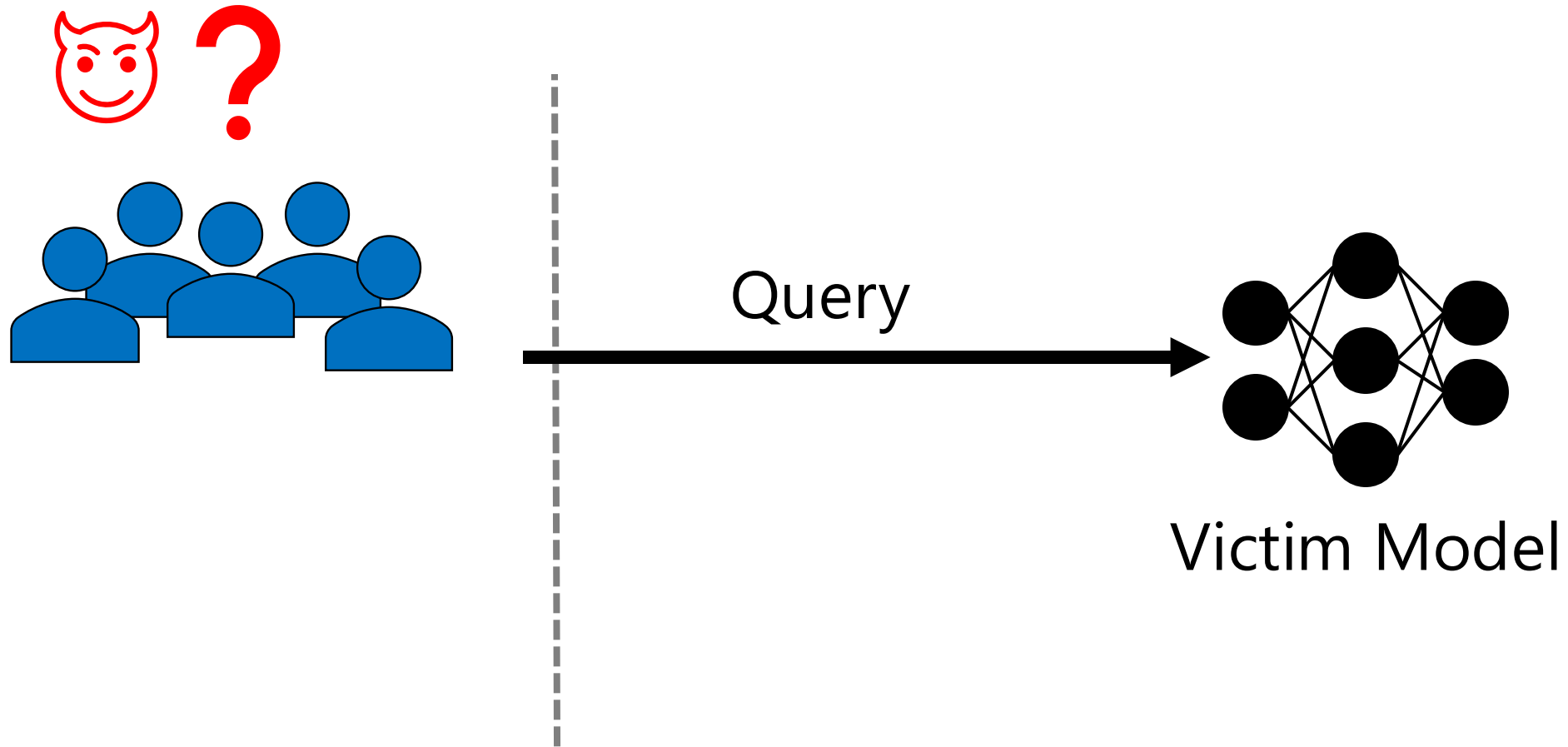


[Dziedzic et al. ICLR 2022]

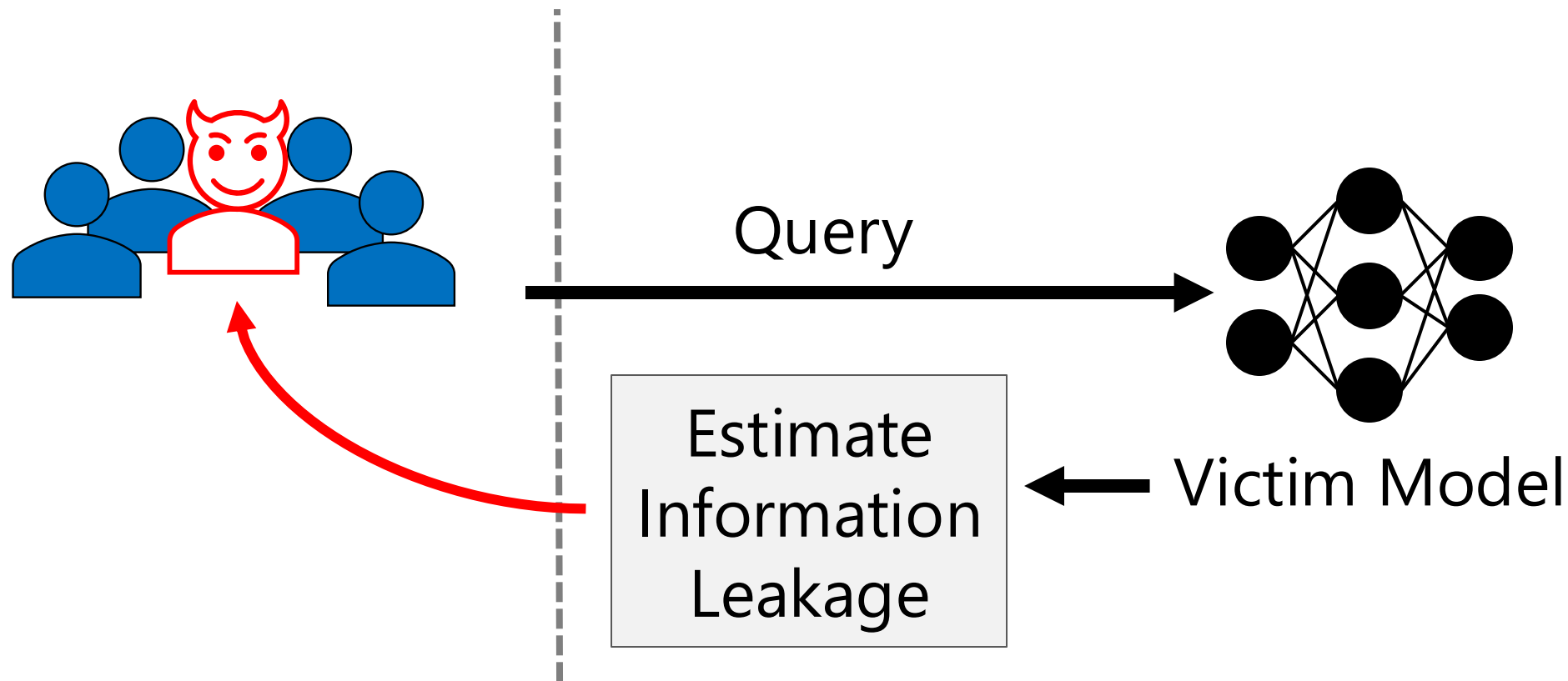
1st Proactive Defense!

Trade robustness for higher cost

Increase Attack Cost for Malicious Users



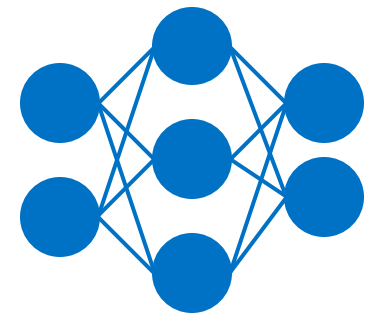
Increase Attack Cost for Malicious Users



Create a User Account to Query the Model

Attacker

Defender

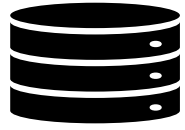


Victim
Model



Adam Dziedzic, Muhammad Ahmad Kaleem, Yu Shen Lu, Nicolas Papernot *"Increasing the Cost of Model Extraction with Calibrated Proof of Work"* [ICLR 2022 **SPOTLIGHT**]

Estimate Victim Model Information Leakage



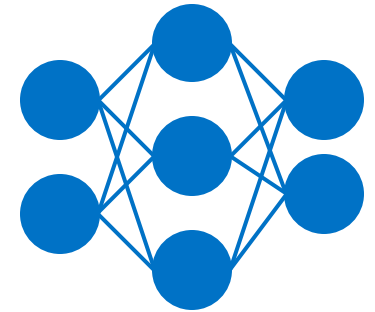
Unlabeled
Data

Attacker

Defender

Send Queries

Estimate
Information
Leakage

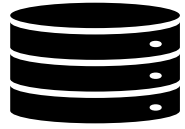


Victim
Model



Adam Dziedzic, Muhammad Ahmad Kaleem, Yu Shen Lu, Nicolas Papernot *"Increasing the Cost of Model Extraction with Calibrated Proof of Work"* [ICLR 2022 **SPOTLIGHT**]

Generate Calibrated Proof-of-Work Puzzle



Unlabeled
Data

Attacker

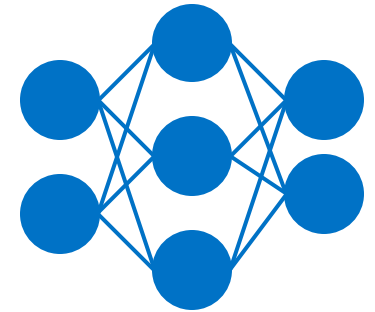
Defender

Send Queries



Generate
PoW Puzzle

Estimate
Information
Leakage

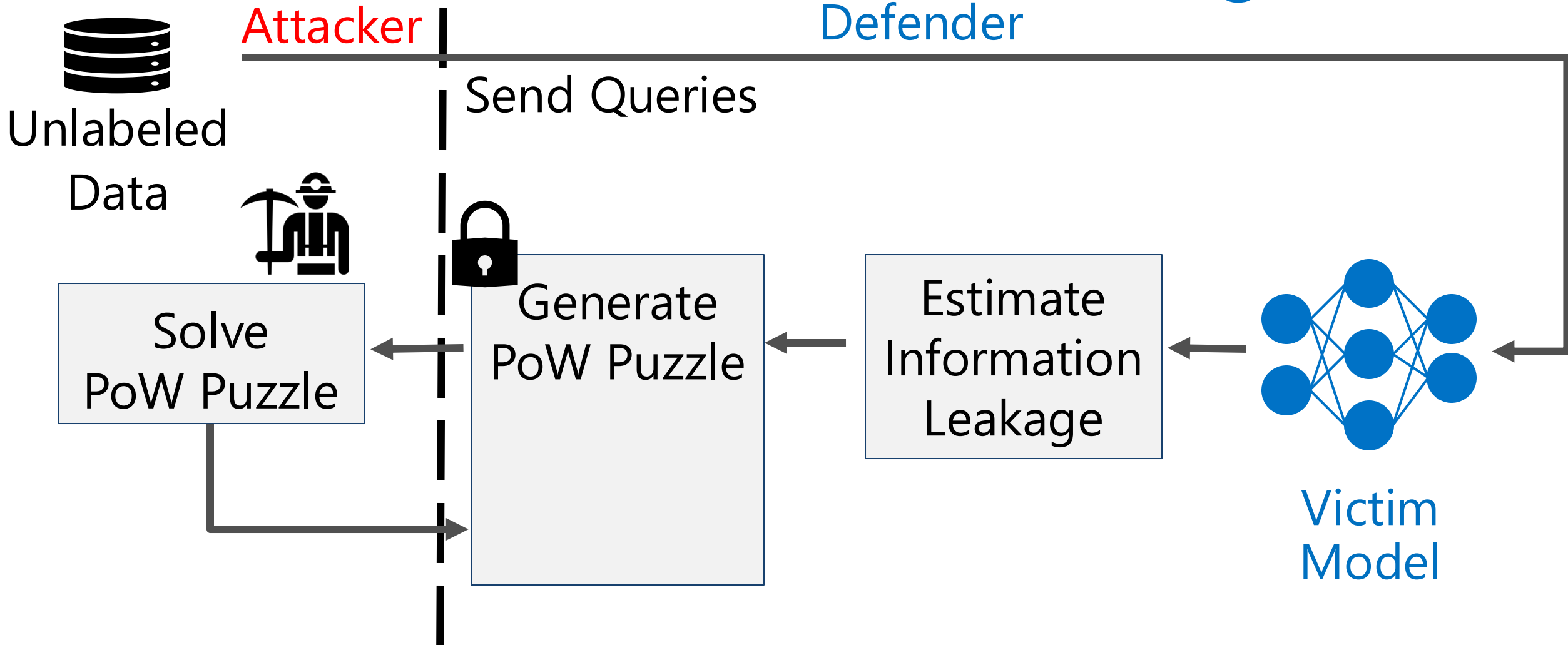


Victim
Model



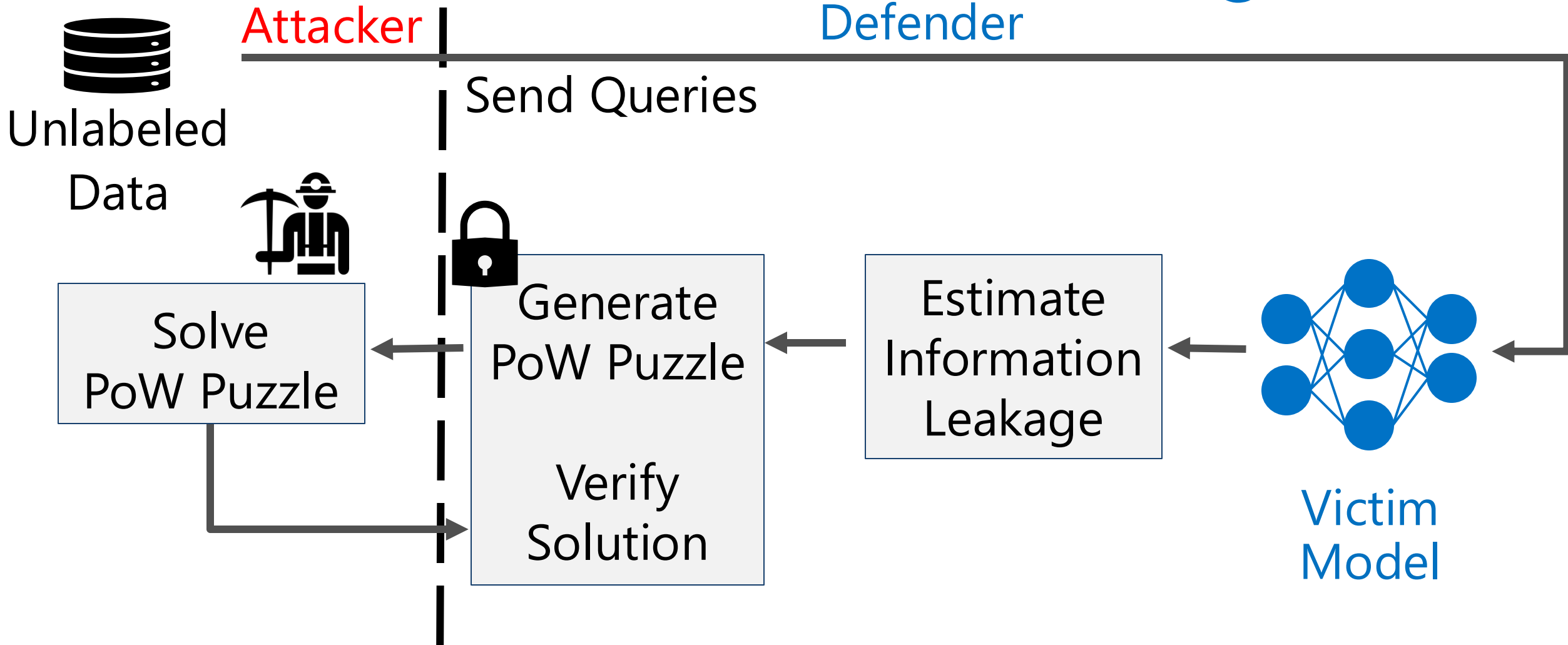
Adam Dziedzic, Muhammad Ahmad Kaleem, Yu Shen Lu, Nicolas Papernot *"Increasing the Cost of Model Extraction with Calibrated Proof of Work"* [ICLR 2022 **SPOTLIGHT**]

Increase the Cost of Model Stealing Attacks



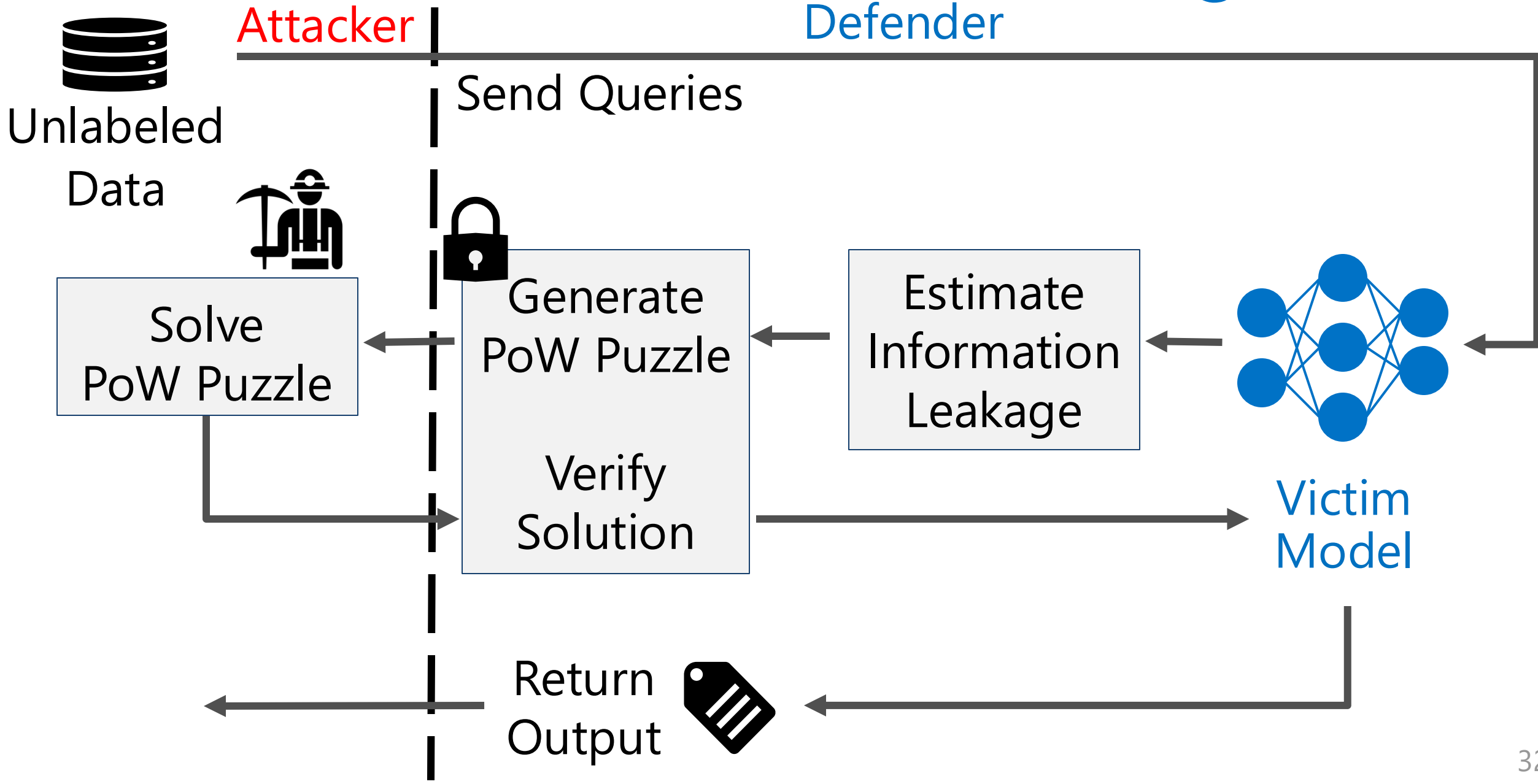
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Increase the Cost of Model Stealing Attacks

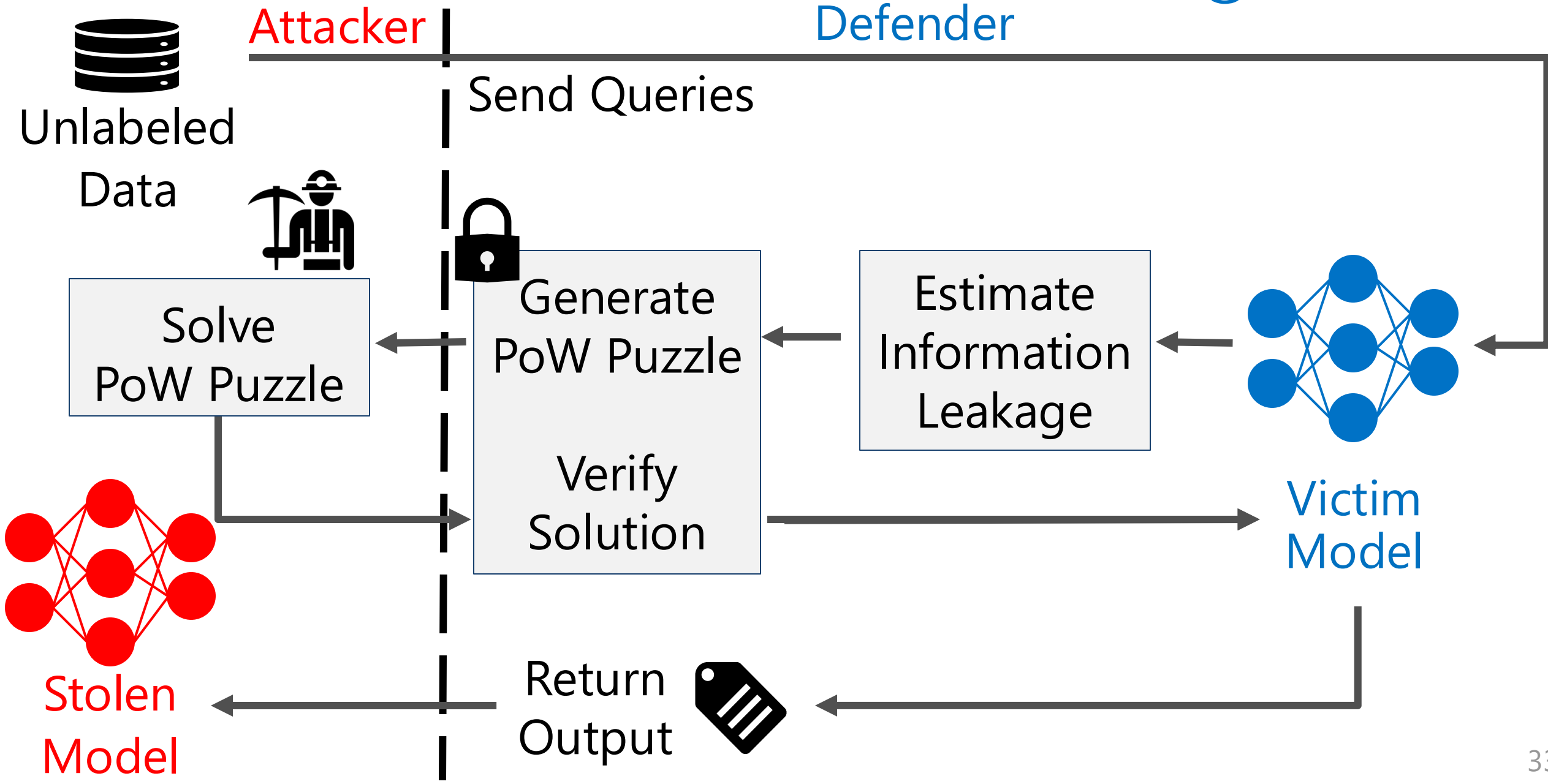


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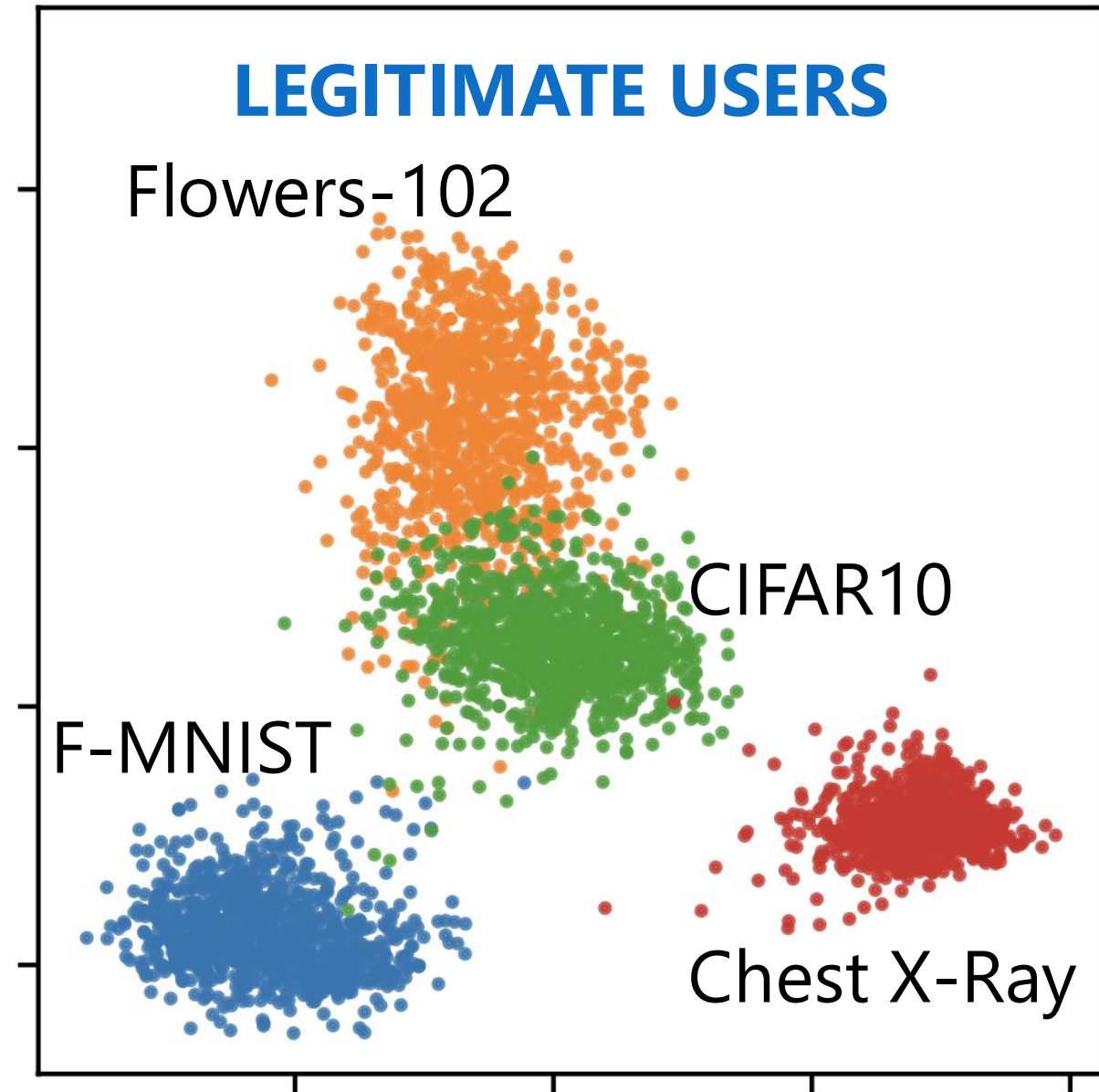
Increase the Cost of Model Stealing Attacks



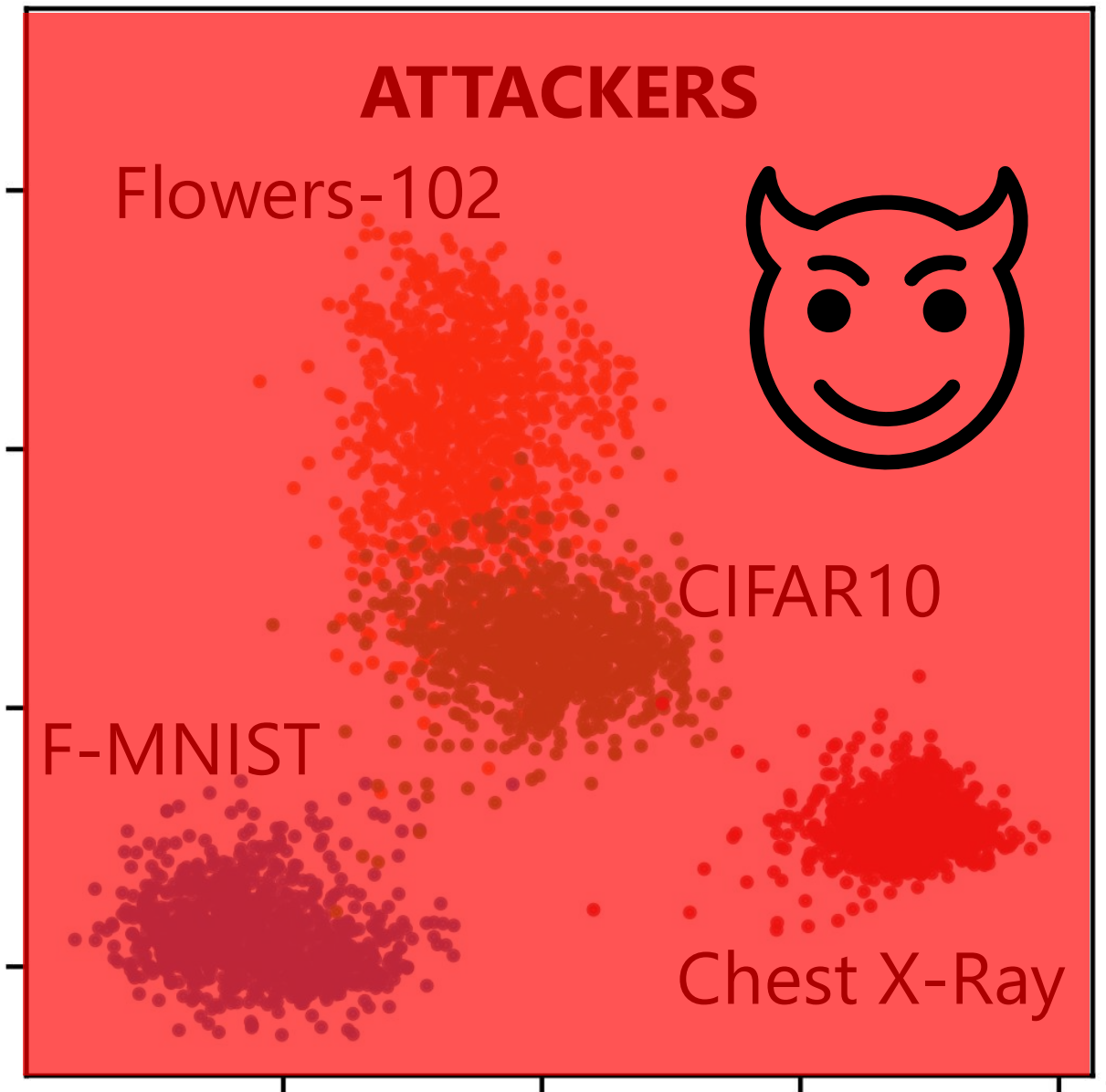
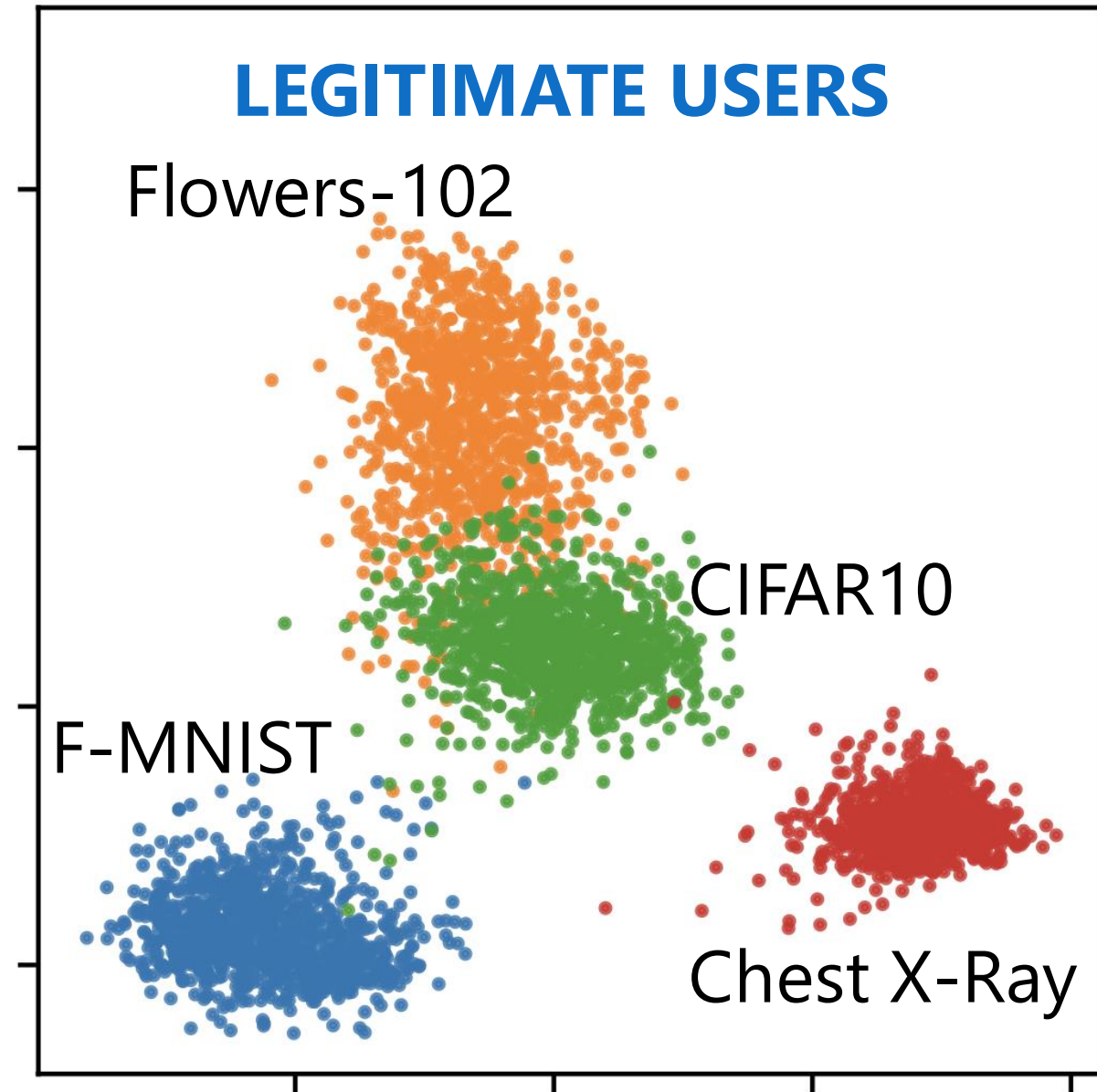
Increase the Cost of Model Stealing Attacks



Legitimate Users Occupy Small Output Spaces

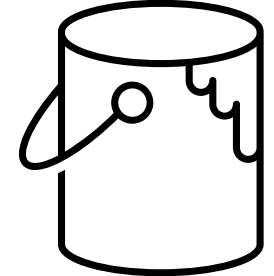
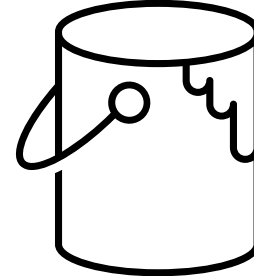
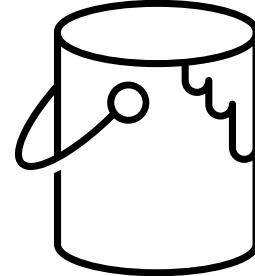


Attackers Occupy the Entire Output Space



Divide the Model's Space into Buckets (B4B)

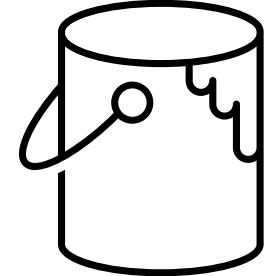
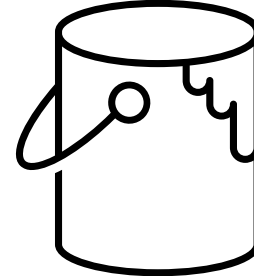
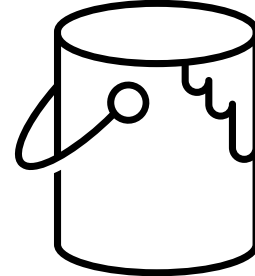
Legitimate User:
Low Cost



*Jan Dubiński, Stanisław Pawlak, Franziska Boenisch, Tomasz Trzciński, **Adam Dziedzic**.*
"Bucks for Buckets (B4B): Active Defenses Against Stealing Encoders" [NeurIPS 2023]

Divide the Model's Space into Buckets (B4B)

Legitimate User:
Low Cost

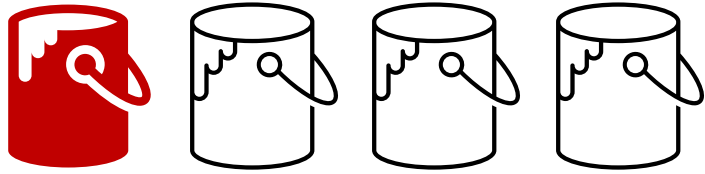


Adversary:
High Cost

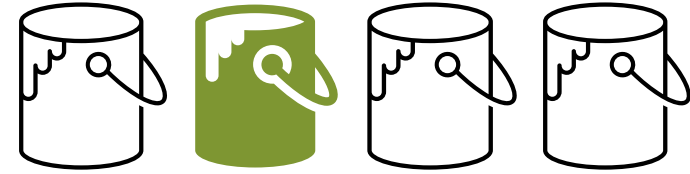


*Jan Dubiński, Stanisław Pawlak, Franziska Boenisch, Tomasz Trzciński, **Adam Dziedzic**. "Bucks for Buckets (B4B): Active Defenses Against Stealing Encoders" [NeurIPS 2023]*

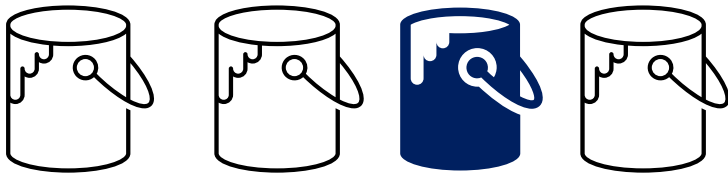
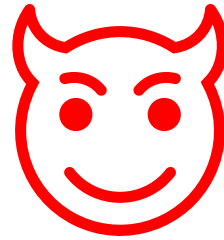
Sybil Attacks: Query from Many Fake Accounts



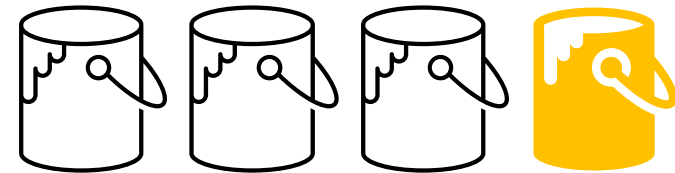
Account 1



Account 2



Account 3



Account 4

Sybil Attackers Cannot Unify Model Outputs

0.9	0.2	0.3	-0.4
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Initial Representation

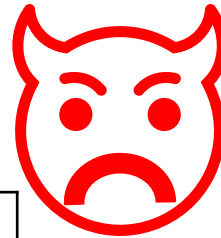
Account 1

0.9	0.2	0.3	-0.4
0.2	0.9	-0.4	0.3

Shuffle Elements

Account 2

?



0.9	0.2	0.3	0.5	-0.4
-----	-----	-----	-----	------

Add values

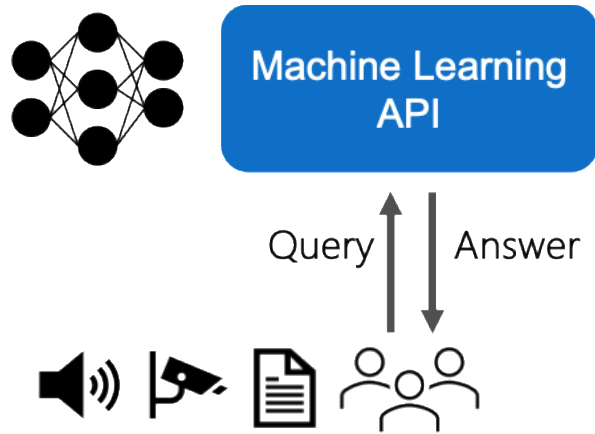
Account 3

2 x 0.9	2 x 0.2	2 x 0.3	2 x -0.4
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Linear Transform

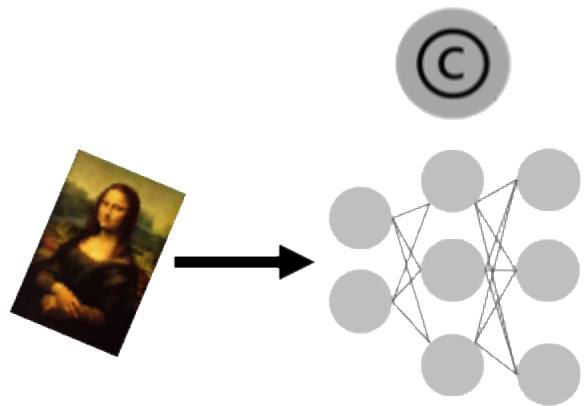
Account 4

Model Stealing and Defenses



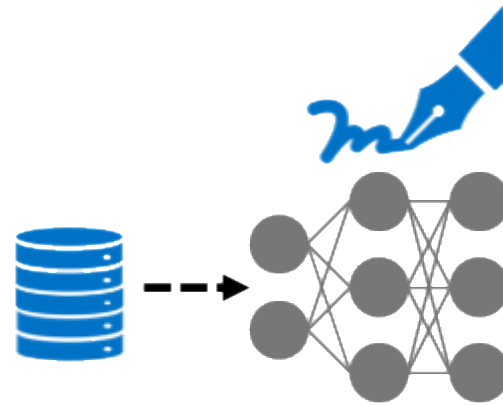
Models Exposed via APIs

- Reconnaissance
- Steal Model
- Steal Data



Watermarking

[**Dziedzic** et al. ICML 2022]



Data-set Inference

[**Dziedzic** et al. NeurIPS 2022]

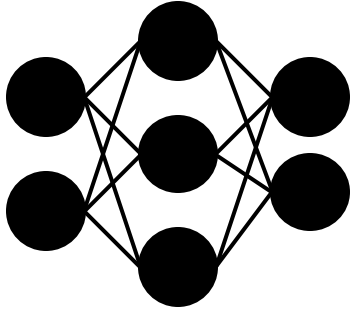
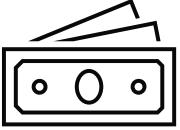


Active Defenses

[(...) **Dziedzic**. NeurIPS 2023]

Future Work against Model Stealing

\$12M GPT-3



Machine Learning
API

Query

Answer

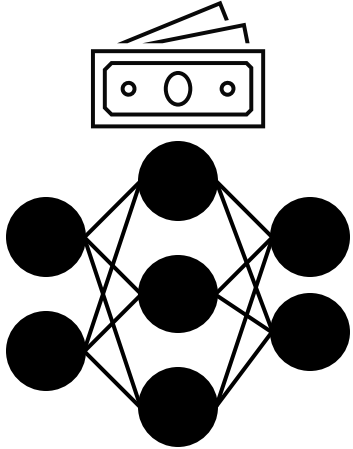
Distill?



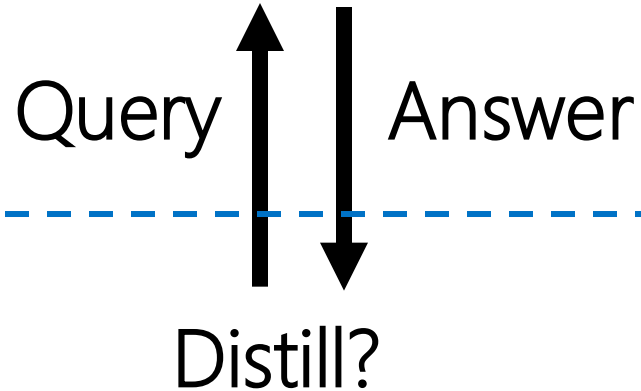
deepseek

Future Work against Model Stealing

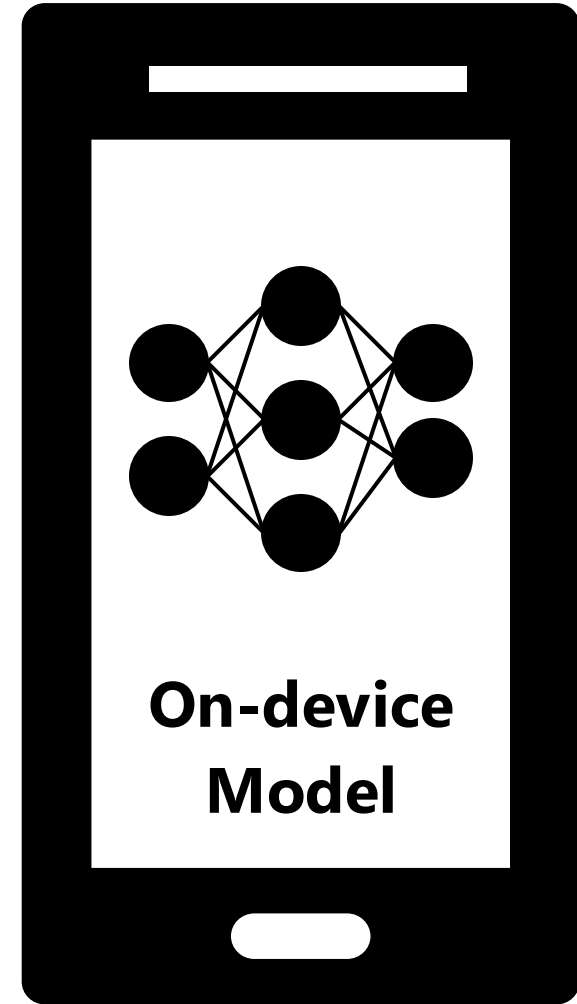
\$12M GPT-3

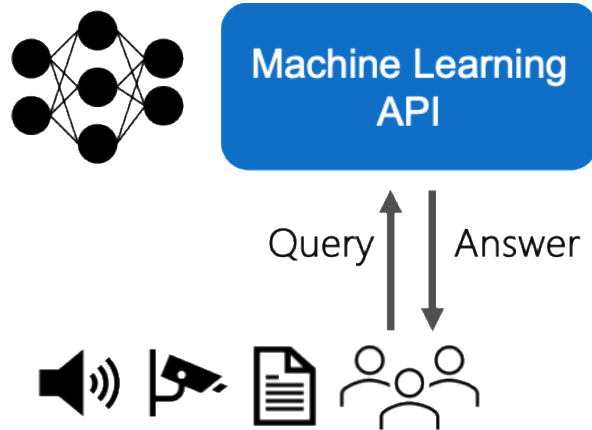


Machine Learning
API

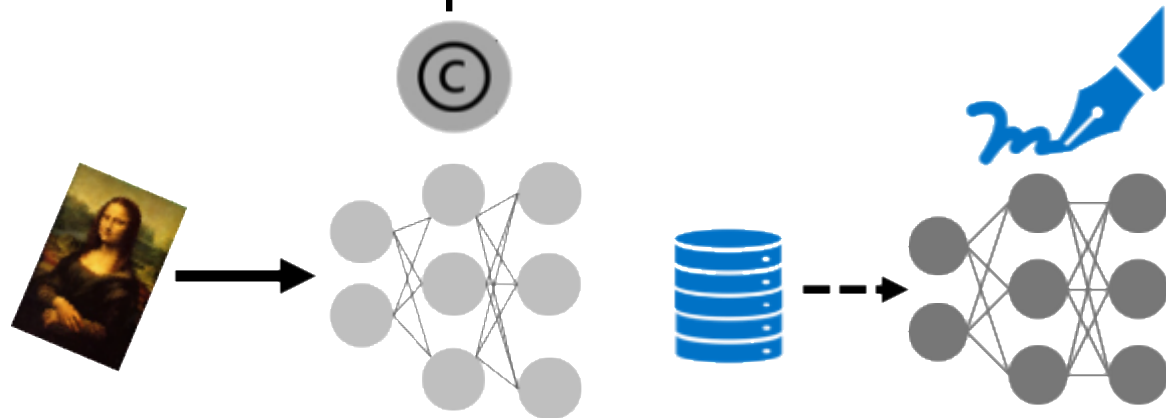


deepseek





Models Exposed via APIs



Watermarking

[Dziedzic et al. ICML 2022]

Data-set Inference

[Dziedzic et al. NeurIPS 2022]

Active Defenses

[(...) Dziedzic. NeurIPS 2023]

- Reconnaissance
- Steal Model
- Steal Data

